

Harvard Continental Climate Workshop

May 22-23, 2025

Organizers: Kaighin McColl (Harvard) and David Battisti (University of Washington), with funding from the National Science Foundation and the Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability.

Location: The workshop will be held at the Harvard University Center for the Environment (HUCE). Here are [detailed directions to HUCE](#).

[Harvard University Center for the Environment \(HUCE\)](#)
26 Oxford St, 4th floor, Cambridge, MA 02138
617-495-0368

Accommodation: All attendees without accommodation in the greater Boston area will be provided lodging at Hotel 1868 in Porter Square, Cambridge, for the nights of May 21, 22 and 23. The hotel is a 15 minute walk from HUCE. If we are providing lodging, you should have received an email confirmation of your reservation already – if not, please contact Stephanie Clayman.

[Hotel 1868](#)
1868 Massachusetts Ave, Cambridge, MA 02140
617-499-2998

Meals and refreshments: A light breakfast, as well as lunch, dinner and coffee will be provided each day. All meals and refreshments will be held in HUCE. The one exception to this will be dinner on May 22 at 6:00 PM at a nearby restaurant, a 10 minute walk from HUCE.

[Harvest](#)
44 Brattle St, Cambridge MA 02138
(On the walkway, directly across the street from the Church St/Brattle St intersection)
617-868-2255

Talks: Each speaker will have 30 minutes in total. Please aim to speak for no more than 20 minutes, to allow plenty of time for questions and discussion. To facilitate smooth transitions between speakers, we plan to have all slide presentations downloaded to a local Mac laptop (PC users: please consider saving your slides as a PDF to avoid compatibility problems). We will email you a link to a OneDrive folder for presentations. Please upload your slides prior to your presentation. Please also bring a backup copy on a thumb drive or laptop.

Internet access: Harvard provides internet access for visitors through eduroam.

Contact:

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Agenda

Day 1 (May 22)

8:30-9:00 am	Breakfast	
SESSION 1		
9:00-9:10	Introduction: Kaighin McColl and David Battisti	
9:10-9:40	Rong Fu	Can South American rainfall influence climate variability over Atlantic Ocean and adjacent continents?
9:40-10:10	Peter Huybers	On rainfall having greater memory in observations than simulations
10:10-10:40	Paul O’Gorman	Understanding the global pattern of precipitation extremes over land
10:40-11:10	Break	
SESSION 2		
11:10-11:40	William Boos	Atmospheric waves and the precipitation around tropical mountains
11:40-12:10 pm	Michael Byrne	Energetic perspectives on elevation dependent warming
12:10-1:00	Discussion (Moderator: Karen McKinnon)	
1:00-1:40	Lunch at HUCE	
SESSION 3		
1:40-2:10	Flavio Lehner	Uncertainties in projections of terrestrial water availability: from teleconnections to runoff sensitivity
2:10-2:40	Justin Mankin	Precipitation consolidation, terrestrial water storage, and flooding
2:40-3:10	Kaighin McColl	Climate-scale variability in soil moisture explained by a simple theory
3:10-3:30	Break	
SESSION 4		
3:30-4:00	David Battisti	Soil moisture teleconnections and summertime temperature variability in the western United States
4:00-4:30	Karen McKinnon	The missing brightening of the US West
4:30-5:20	Discussion (Moderator: Lucas Vargas Zeppetello)	
6:00	Dinner at Harvest	

Day 2 (May 23)

8:30-9:00 am	Breakfast	
SESSION 1		
9:00-9:30	Daniel Gianotti	Dominant mechanisms of landscape water-carbon coordination
9:30-10:00	Paul Moorcroft	Environmental drivers of spatial variation in tropical forest canopy height: Insights from NASA's GEDI spaceborne LiDAR
10:00-10:30	Lucas Vargas Zeppetello	Understanding plant-climate relations with a simple model
10:30-11:00	Break	
SESSION 2		
11:00-11:30	Paolo D'ODorico	Fire-precipitation interactions in African savannas
11:30-12:00 pm	Angela Rigden	Spatial and temporal patterns of water availability in sub-Saharan Africa
12-12:50	Discussion (Moderator: Marysa Laguë)	
12:50-2:00	Lunch at HUCE	
SESSION 3		
2:00-2:30	Guido Salvucci	Further insights into evaporation based on boundary layer dynamics
2:30-3:00	Marysa Laguë	Cloud feedbacks to stomatal closure
3:00-3:30	Abigail Swann	Quantifying the drivers of evapotranspiration over land under current and future conditions
3:30-4:00	Break	
4:00-5:00	Discussion (Moderator: David Battisti)	
5:00	Dinner at HUCE	